

IGBO MASTERY

Igbo Starter Cheat Sheet · tones · alphabet · first words

igbomastery.com

THE TONES — pitch is meaning

Written without marks, akwa is one word.

Spoken four ways, it is four words:

ákwá	— cry
àkwá	— egg
ákwa	— cloth
àkwà	— bed

eze can mean king or teeth — tone decides.

THE ALPHABET — 36 letters

Vowels: a e i i̇ o ọ u ụ

Digraphs: ch gb gh gw kp kw nw ny sh

q and x are not used in standard Igbo.

THE DOTTED LETTERS — not decoration

ì	tight “ih”
ọ	“aw” of saw
ụ	“oo” of book
ñ	starting “ng”

GREETINGS

Ndeewo!	Hello / Welcome
Kedu ka i mere?	How are you?
Ọ dị mma.	I'm fine.
Aha m bụ ...	My name is ...
Daalụ.	Thank you.
Biko.	Please.
Ka ọ dị.	Goodbye.

NUMBERS & MONEY

otu	— 1	abụọ	— 2
atọ	— 3	anọ	— 4
ise	— 5	isii	— 6
asaa	— 7	asatọ	— 8
itoolu	— 9	iri	— 10
iri abụọ	— 20	otu narị	— 100
otu puku	— 1,000		

Ego ole?	How much?
Ọ dị ọnụ.	It's expensive.

FAMILY & PEOPLE

nne	mother
nna	father
nwa	child
nwanne	sibling
nwoke	man
nwaanyị	woman
ụmụ	children
umunna	kinsfolk

FOOD & MARKET

nri	food
ofe	soup
ji	yam
mmiri	water
ahịa	market
ego	money

PROVERBS (ILU)

Gidi gidi bụ ugwu eze.

Unity is strength.

Oge adịghị eche mmadụ.

Time and tide wait for nobody.

Onye ajughị ase,

The person who asks questions

anaghị efu ụzọ.

does not lose the way.

DAILY LIFE

ụlọ	house
ụlọ akwụkwọ	school